

Example Ltd

ISO 9001:2015 — Audit Preparation Companion

Tailored audit readiness guide
for mechanical & electrical installations
in commercial and public sector buildings

Accompanies Quality Manual · Valid for Stage 1/2 Preparation

Issued: 21 May 2026

Locale: UK (en-GB) | Designed for: Example Ltd, Coventry

For use with Quality Manual v1.0

Welcome.

This Audit Preparation Companion provides a structured, company-specific guide to help Example Ltd demonstrate live operation of your ISO 9001 Quality Management System ahead of a certification audit. All content is rooted in your own quality manual, actual processes, and the KPIs and controls set out for your mechanical and electrical contracting business in the West Midlands.

For each major ISO topic (Context, Leadership, Planning, Operation, Performance Evaluation, Improvement), you will find practical, likely auditor questions, the real-world evidence you will need to produce, what “recent enough” means for each item, and a focused roadmap from now to Stage 2 audit.

Auditors expect to see evidence that matches how you operate — not generic templates. References in this companion are fully personalised to your team (Gareth Pryce, Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, Ricky Obeng), your actual project delivery steps, your KPIs, supplier and equipment details, and your risk environment.

Context and Leadership

Auditor Question Catalogue

- ☐ Example Ltd says “quality means getting the job done right and safely the first time”. Can you show how this expectation is communicated to site operatives, and how you monitor this in practice?
- ☐ Your scope covers mechanical and electrical installation and maintenance for commercial/public buildings. How do you ensure works outside scope (e.g., standalone domestic jobs or third-party sublets) are not accidentally included?
- ☐ Responsibilities for the QMS are assigned to Gareth Pryce (Owner/MD), with no separate Quality Manager. How do you ensure accountability for quality across the team, given your lean structure?
- ☐ Main risks identified include late materials/plant, expired operatives' cards, and incomplete test packs. Show how these risks are formally reviewed and who is informed when a risk materialises on a job.
- ☐ Your manual refers to compliance with CDM, BS 7671 and Gas Safe — how do you keep up to date with changes in these regulations, and who ensures all staff are informed?

Evidence Required

- ☐ Signed and dated quality policy, as currently displayed/issued to staff
- ☐ Records or minutes of briefings or toolbox talks where “right first time” quality expectations are discussed (attendee lists, topics covered, dates)
- ☐ Documented QMS scope statement, showing inclusions and explicit exclusions
- ☐ Organisation chart or written roles/responsibility summaries (showing Gareth Pryce, Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, Ricky Obeng)
- ☐ Risk register or risk log for common issues (e.g., late deliveries, certificate expiries), with evidence of regular review and documented actions
- ☐ Meeting notes, emails, or memos showing system/process updates in response to regulatory changes

Timing & Frequency Requirements

- ☐ Quality policy should be current and reviewed at least annually, or after major regulatory or client changes
- ☐ Staff briefings/toolbox talks: evidence within the past 6–12 months preferred
- ☐ Risk reviews: records should cover live operation over at least 3 months; must precede Stage 2 audit
- ☐ Roles and responsibility documents: reflect current team as of audit date
- ☐ Document retention “as per applicable UK legal requirements” (typical: policy and structure evidence for 3–6 years)

Planning and Support

Auditor Question Catalogue

- ☐ Your quality objectives include raising on-time job completion from ~80% to 95%, and reducing average snagging items to 10 or fewer per job by end of 2026. Can you show the actual tracking method and who reviews the results?
- ☐ How do you ensure that Lee Hammond (Site Manager) and Joanne Clarke (Office Manager) are always aware of when operatives' CSCS/ECS/gas tickets or equipment calibration certificates are due for renewal?
- ☐ What process do you follow when selecting or changing suppliers? Can you show documentation for a recent supplier review or decision to change merchant?
- ☐ How is document control managed in daily operation? Can Joanne Clarke demonstrate the process for ensuring only up-to-date test certificates and O&M records are used and handed over?
- ☐ How is competence of new operatives checked before they work unsupervised on site?

Evidence Required

- ☐ KPI tracking records (actuals against target for: programme completion, snagging items, completed test packs)
- ☐ Samples of monthly or quarterly KPI reports/graphs reviewed by Gareth Pryce
- ☐ Log or calendar evidencing advance reminders for card/certificate renewals (CSCS/ECS/gas/calibration), with owner (usually Ricky Obeng)
- ☐ Supplier evaluation/review notes (including rationale for picking, reviewing or switching a wholesaler/merchant/plant hire company)
- ☐ List of approved suppliers with notes/dates of last review
- ☐ Document control records: version logs, example electronic or printed pack with status clearly marked (in use, superseded, archived)
- ☐ Training/competency records for site operatives (copies of CSCS/ECS cards, gas safe registrations, induction/training evidence)

Timing & Frequency Requirements

- ☐ KPI data: minimum 3 months' live records expected prior to Stage 2 audit; latest available
- ☐ Calibration records and certification: must be current (annual calibration as minimum for critical equipment)
- ☐ Supplier reviews: at least annual, with evidence of last review within the last 12 months
- ☐ Document control and training records: up-to-date, and for retention as per UK legal and client requirements (common: 6 years for installation/test documents)

Operation and Performance Evaluation

Auditor Question Catalogue

- ☐ Walk me through how you prepare, check, and approve installation works on a typical project (from contract award to handover), naming who is responsible for each step.
- ☐ Give an example of how a nonconformance (such as an incomplete commissioning pack or late delivery) was logged, investigated, and resolved. Show me where this was recorded and closed out.
- ☐ How does Joanne Clarke ensure all delivery notes/materials received on site are checked properly against orders and specification? What happens if there is a discrepancy?
- ☐ Can you evidence a recent internal audit, its planning, findings, and how any actions were closed by the relevant managers?
- ☐ How is calibration of test instruments (e.g., MFTs, PAT testers) monitored and enforced? Who cannot work if their cert is out of date?

Evidence Required

- ☐ Job file for a recently completed project, including signed programmes, RAMS, materials schedules, delivery notes, installation checklists, test/commissioning certs and snagging/hand over documents
- ☐ Nonconformance log with sample entries (issue description, logged by Joanne Clarke, investigation by Lee Hammond on site, action/closure by Gareth or Lee)
- ☐ Evidence of communication/escalation for late materials or inspection failures (e.g., emails, site diaries, meeting notes)
- ☐ Internal audit plan and associated audit report(s) (at least one covering project delivery, procurement, calibration or document control within the last 12 months)
- ☐ Calibration register for test instruments/plant (maintained by Ricky Obeng), with certificate copies showing renewals are current
- ☐ Training/authorisation records showing who is permitted to operate calibrated instruments

Timing & Frequency Requirements

- ☐ Internal audit: at least annually; should cover all key processes over the audit cycle
- ☐ Nonconformance log: demonstrate at least 3 months' operation before Stage 2 audit; entries should be current and "closed out" with actions
- ☐ Calibration records: next due date clearly shown; evidence of recent lab certificates (typically annual)
- ☐ Project files: evidence from jobs finished in the past 6–12 months preferred
- ☐ Retention of audit, calibration, and project records should comply with applicable UK requirements and any client/contractual terms (6 years is typical for test/handover documentation)

Management Review and Improvement

Auditor Question Catalogue

- ☐ Show evidence of a formal management review chaired by Gareth Pryce, including discussion of KPI progress and feedback on main risks (programme delays, incomplete certificates, snagging rates).
- ☐ How are actions and decisions from management reviews assigned and monitored for completion?
- ☐ Have you made any process changes recently based on lessons learned from recurring snagging or customer complaints? Please show relevant meeting notes or updated procedures.
- ☐ How do you track and evaluate whether improvements implemented—such as new supplier arrangements or revised site checks—are actually effective?

Evidence Required

- ☐ Signed and dated management review minutes, including attendee list (Gareth Pryce, Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, Ricky Obeng), agenda, reviewed KPIs, audit findings, client feedback, and agreed actions
- ☐ Improvement log or action tracker, showing responsibilities and deadlines for post-meeting actions
- ☐ Evidence of process amendments or training rolled out in response to recurring issues (revised checklists, updated procurement or installation procedures, staff communications)
- ☐ Records of follow-up meetings checking effectiveness of changes (meeting notes, tracking sheets, further KPI data)

Timing & Frequency Requirements

- ☐ Management review: at planned intervals; at minimum annually—with at least one review held and documented before Stage 2 audit
- ☐ Improvement and action tracking: live and updated, with recent entries to evidence ongoing activity
- ☐ Process change evidence: showing changes made within the past 12 months (if applicable)
- ☐ Retention on management review notes and logs: as per applicable UK requirements and client contracts (typical: at least 3 years)

FINAL SECTION

Practical Preparation Roadmap

- **First week (after manual approval):** Start active record-keeping for all live jobs and site activities (job files, test certificates, delivery notes, risk log, nonconformance log). Ensure only the latest version of documents are in use. Notify all staff of the QMS policy and scope, with confirmation of understanding (signatures, briefing records).
- Assign formal responsibility for quality data and record keeping: Gareth Pryce oversees, Joanne Clarke manages job/admin files, Ricky Obeng maintains calibration and competence records.
- Review and update the supplier list and confirm last review dates. Ensure calibration and competence logs are up to date for all test equipment and site operatives.
- **Over the next 6–10 weeks:** Gather live evidence of KPI tracking for job completion, snagging, and documentation completion; log at least one nonconformance and resolution (real-world, not hypothetical); if possible, conduct and document an internal audit (covering at minimum delivery, procurement or calibration processes); start monthly reporting to Gareth Pryce.
- Hold at least one completed management review meeting, with KPI data and audit findings as input. Record minutes and assign actions.
- Document any process improvements resulting from actual issues (e.g., if a snag was missed, document how checks are strengthened).
- **Just prior to Stage 2 audit:** Compile working files for all requirements above. Cross-check that evidence references actual projects and named team members. Check all records are filed, up to date, and accessible. Prepare to explain—not just show—how each process is done in practice and who is responsible.

Note: None of the above guarantees certification. It is designed to help you prepare efficiently and avoid common pitfalls in the audit process—by showing how Example Ltd actually operates and improves, not just how you might operate.